NLP-4 Duplicate Question Retrieval: 30-Minute Team Session

Goal of the session: Move from the Week 5 plan to running experiments. By the end, we know where each method stands, which new questions we will test, and who delivers what before the next meeting.

1. Where we stand (about 8 min)

Each member reports their part in two or three sentences: what runs, what the first Recall@K, MRR and retrieval-time numbers look like, and what is stuck. We note anything that looks suspicious, such as a score that is too high (a possible leak or self-retrieval) or a baseline that is too low (a possible bug).

2. Questions we want the results to answer (about 12 min)

We choose two or three of these to work on next:

1. Does combining BM25 and dense retrieval beat either one alone? Any weighting is tuned on the development set only.
2. Where do all methods fail? We read a sample of missed queries and look for patterns in length, word overlap, or paraphrasing.
3. Is the gap between methods real? We use bootstrapped confidence intervals, so small differences are not over-read.
4. How much does reranking depth buy us? We compare 20 against 50 candidates on both quality and time.
5. Can retrieval be made cheaper? We try smaller embeddings or searching only part of the corpus, and measure the loss in Recall@K.

3. Decisions to record (about 6 min)

1. Which experiments do we run, and in what order.
2. Which results go into the report as tables and figures.

4. Before the next meeting (about 4 min)

Each member has one concrete deliverable with a date, for example “BM25 and dense results

on dev, saved in results/”. We also set the next meeting time and agree who commits what to Git.